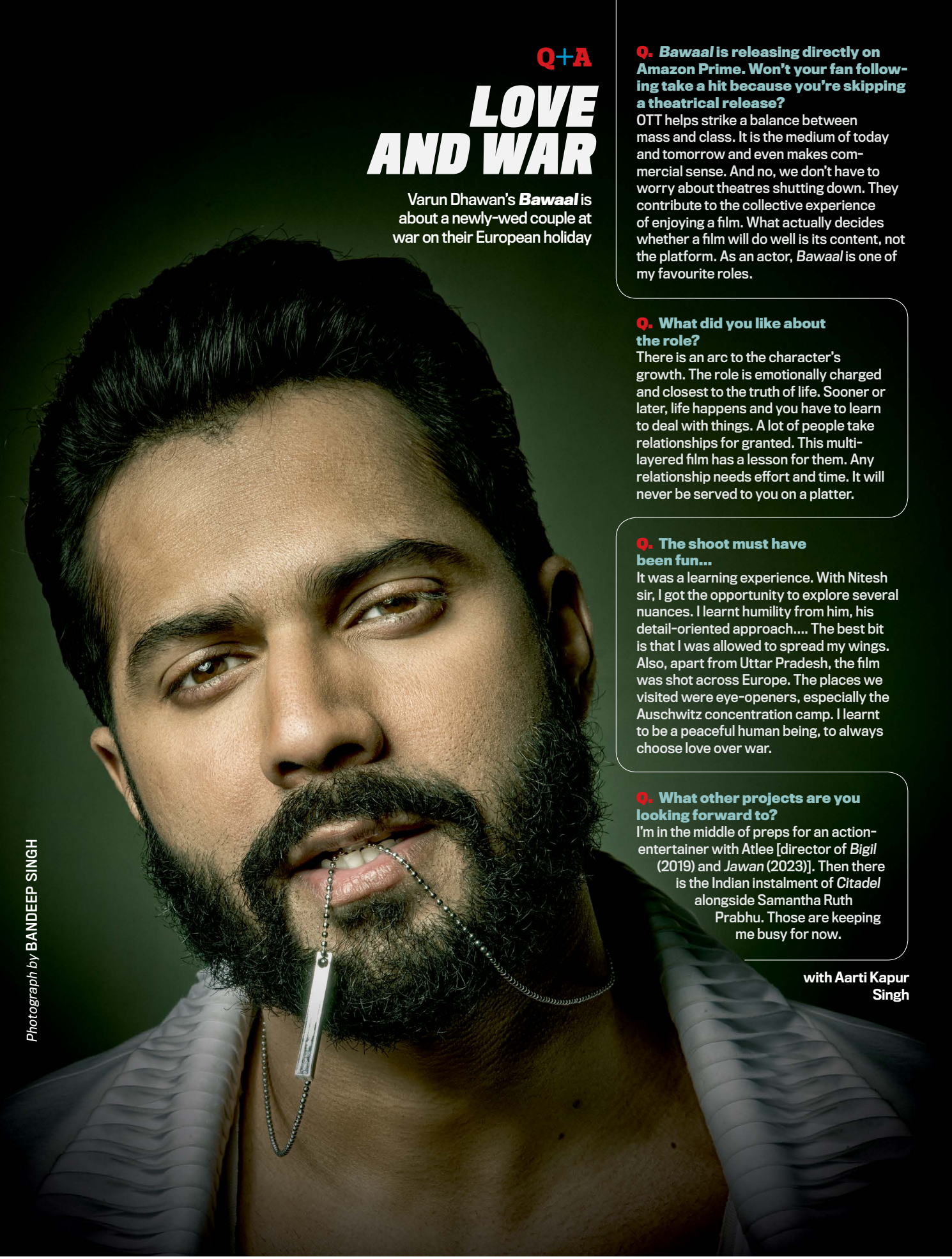
Q+A

LOVE AND WAR

Varun Dhawan's ***Bawaal*** is about a newly-wed couple at war on their European holiday



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

Q. *Bawaal* is releasing directly on Amazon Prime. Won't your fan following take a hit because you're skipping a theatrical release?

OTT helps strike a balance between mass and class. It is the medium of today and tomorrow and even makes commercial sense. And no, we don't have to worry about theatres shutting down. They contribute to the collective experience of enjoying a film. What actually decides whether a film will do well is its content, not the platform. As an actor, *Bawaal* is one of my favourite roles.

Q. What did you like about the role?

There is an arc to the character's growth. The role is emotionally charged and closest to the truth of life. Sooner or later, life happens and you have to learn to deal with things. A lot of people take relationships for granted. This multi-layered film has a lesson for them. Any relationship needs effort and time. It will never be served to you on a platter.

Q. The shoot must have been fun...

It was a learning experience. With Nitesh sir, I got the opportunity to explore several nuances. I learnt humility from him, his detail-oriented approach.... The best bit is that I was allowed to spread my wings. Also, apart from Uttar Pradesh, the film was shot across Europe. The places we visited were eye-openers, especially the Auschwitz concentration camp. I learnt to be a peaceful human being, to always choose love over war.

Q. What other projects are you looking forward to?

I'm in the middle of preps for an action-entertainer with Atlee [director of *Bigil* (2019) and *Jawan* (2023)]. Then there is the Indian instalment of *Citadel* alongside Samantha Ruth Prabhu. Those are keeping me busy for now.

with Aarti Kapur Singh